Premium Instant Fufu Market Insights-January 2026

FIG 1.1

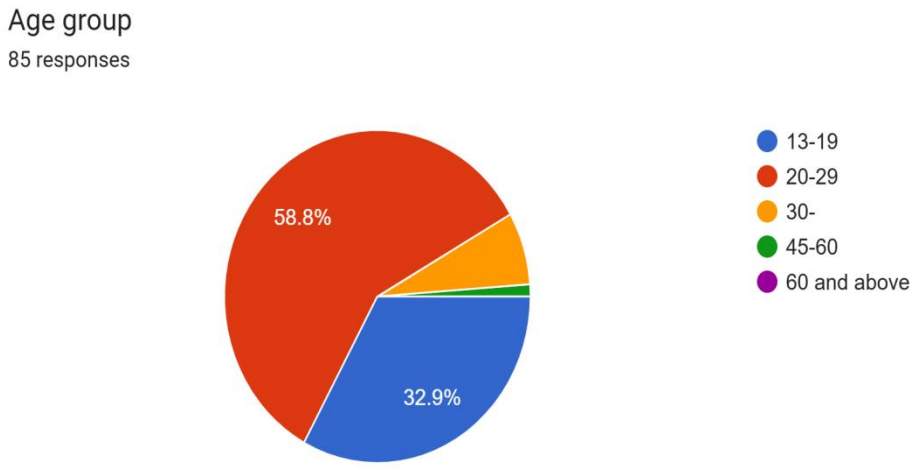


FIG 1.2

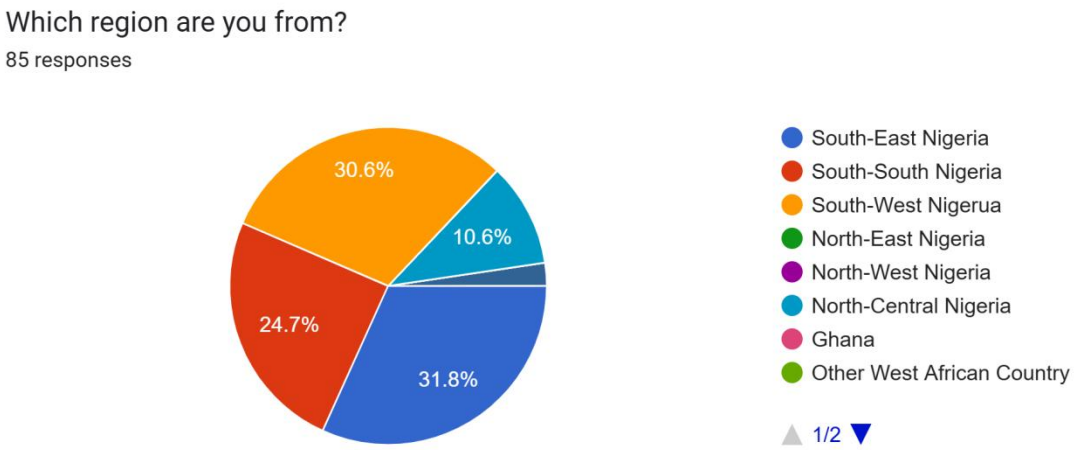
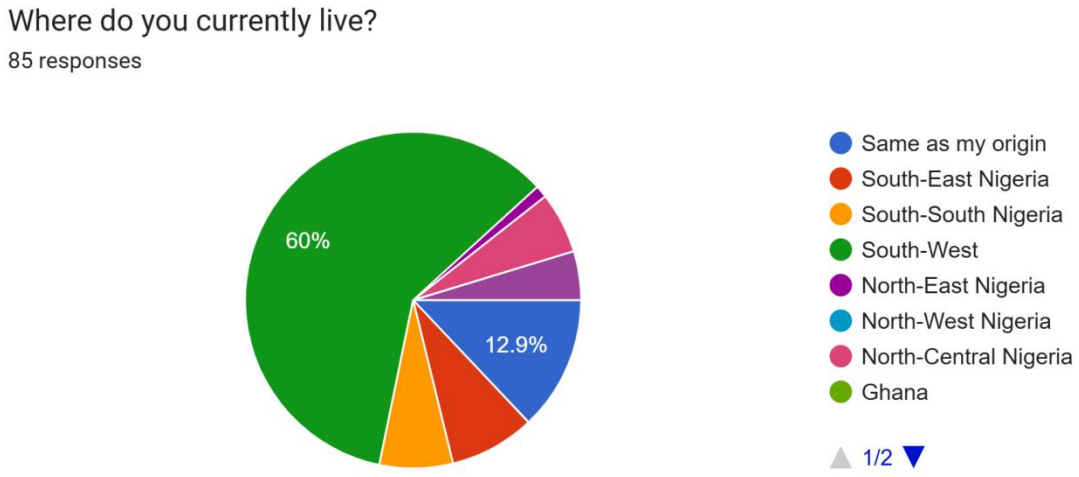


FIG 1.3


Where do you currently live?
85 responses
60%
12.9%
Same as my origin
South-East Nigeria
South-South Nigeria
South-West
North-East Nigeria
North-West Nigeria
North-Central Nigeria
Ghana
1/2

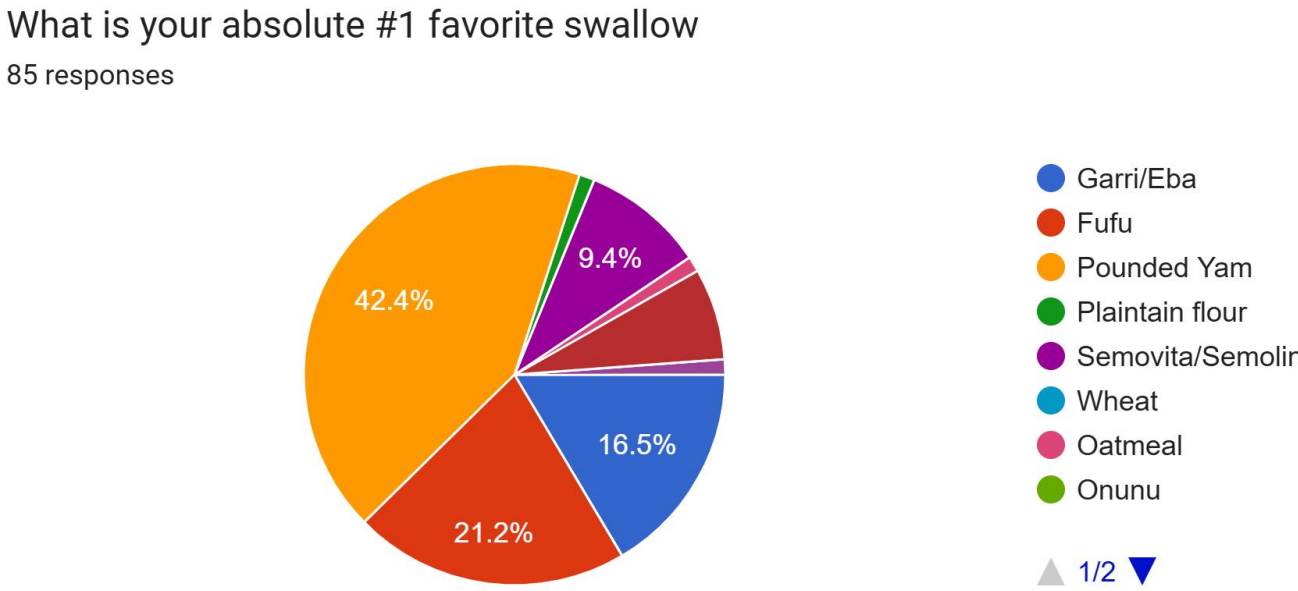

What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
85 responses
42.4%
9.4%
16.5%
21.2%
Garri/Eba
Fufu
Pounded Yam
Plaintain flour
Semovita/Semolin
Wheat
Oatmeal
Onunu
1/2

FIG 1.4

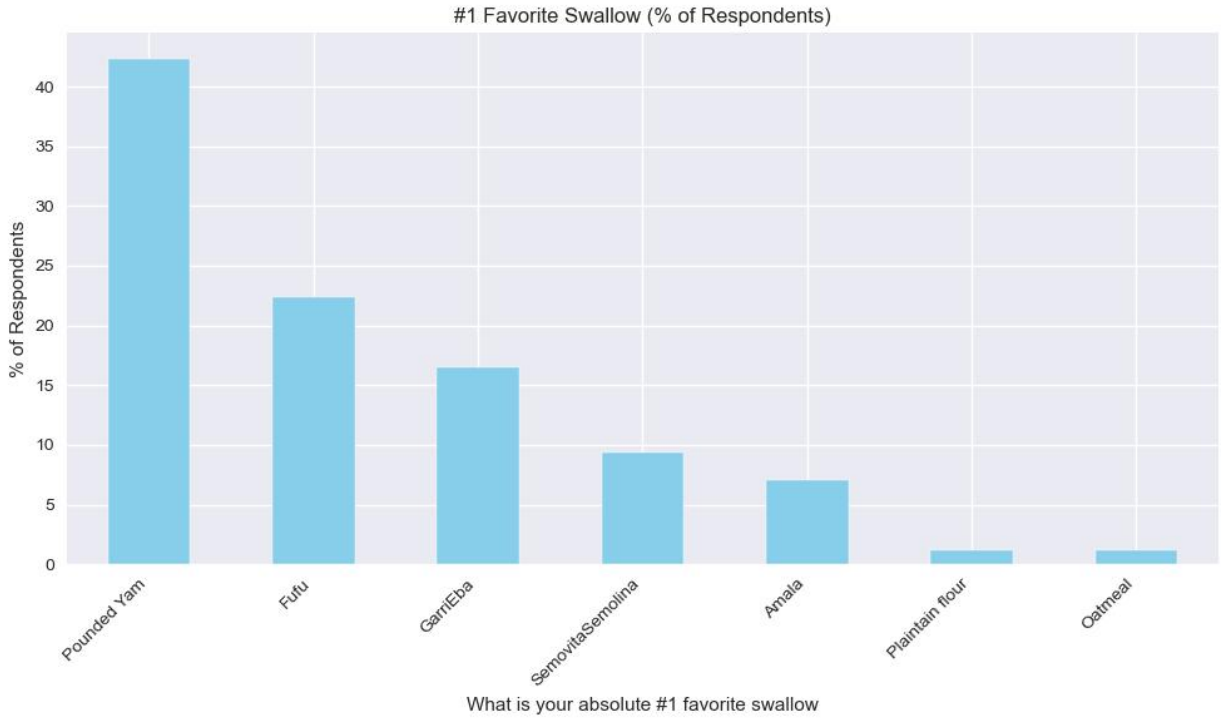

#1 Favorite Swallow (% of Respondents)
% of Respondents
0
5
10
15
20
25
30
35
40
Pounded Yam
Fufu
GarriEba
SemovitaSemolina
Amala
Plaintain flour
Oatmeal
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow

FIG 1.5

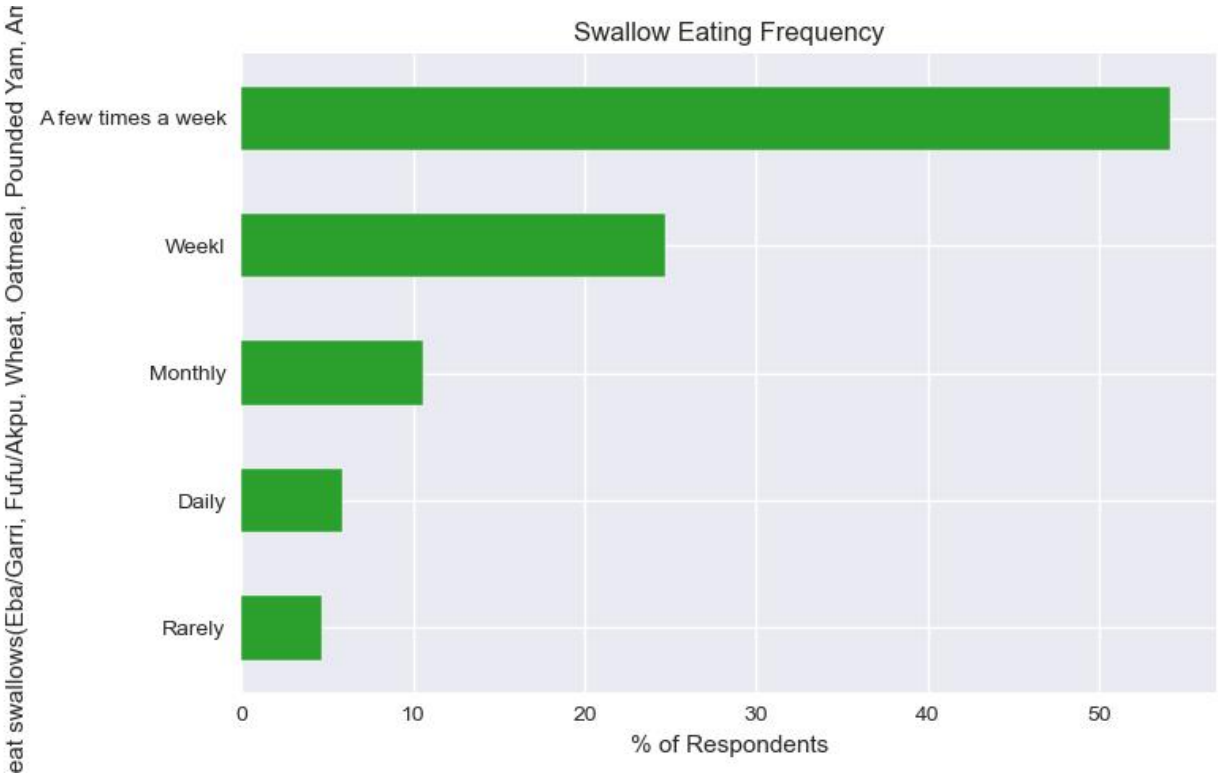

Swallow Eating Frequency
eat swallows(Eba/Garri, Fufu/Akpu, Wheat, Oatmeal, Pounded Yam, An
A few times a week
Weekl
Monthly
Daily
Rarely
0
10
20
30
40
50
% of Respondents

FIG 1.6

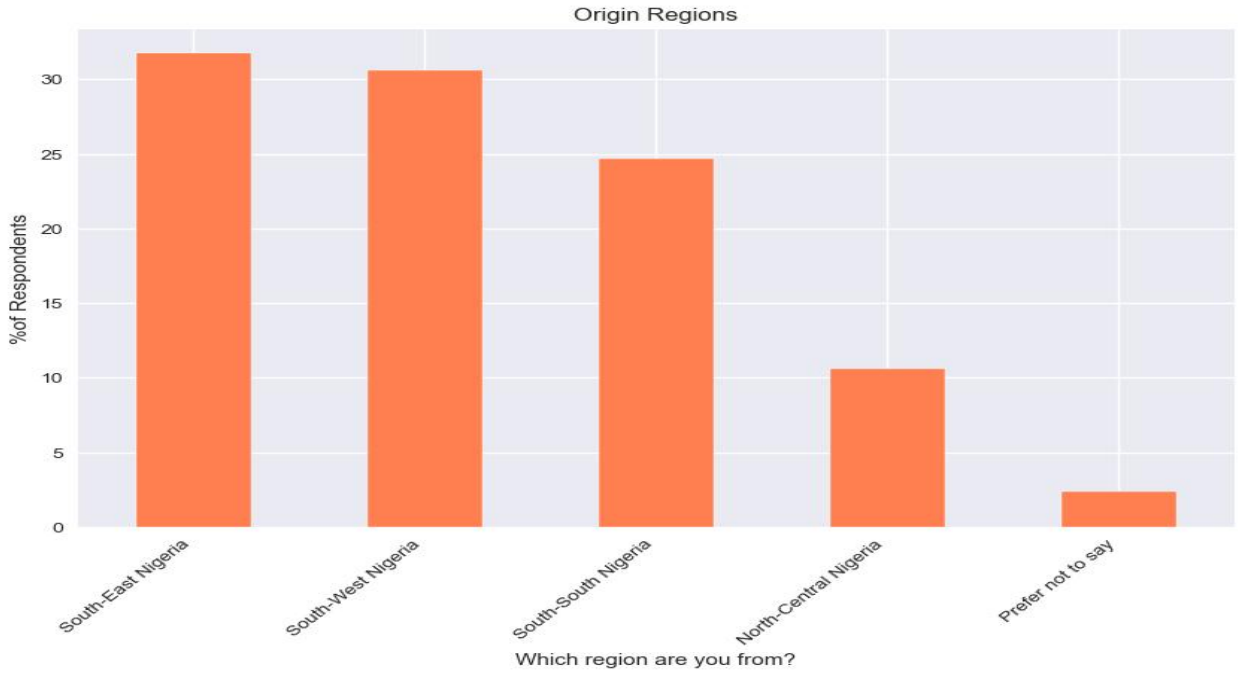
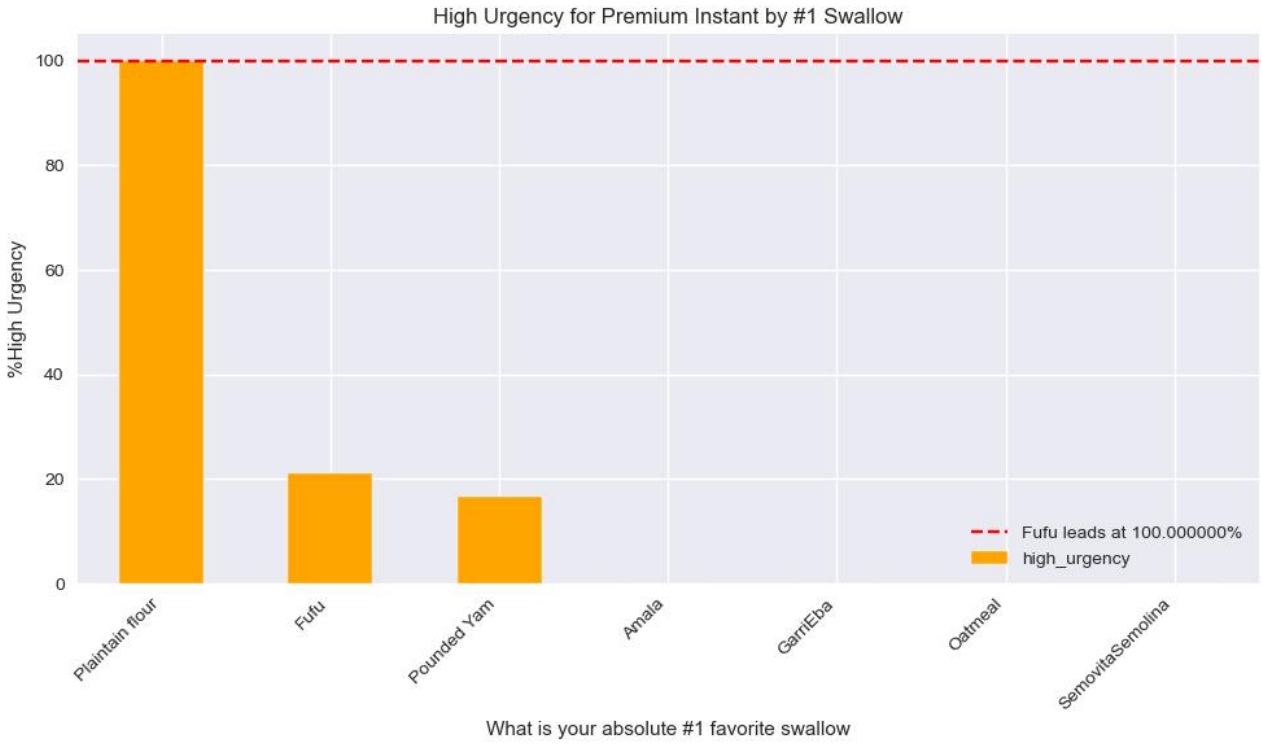
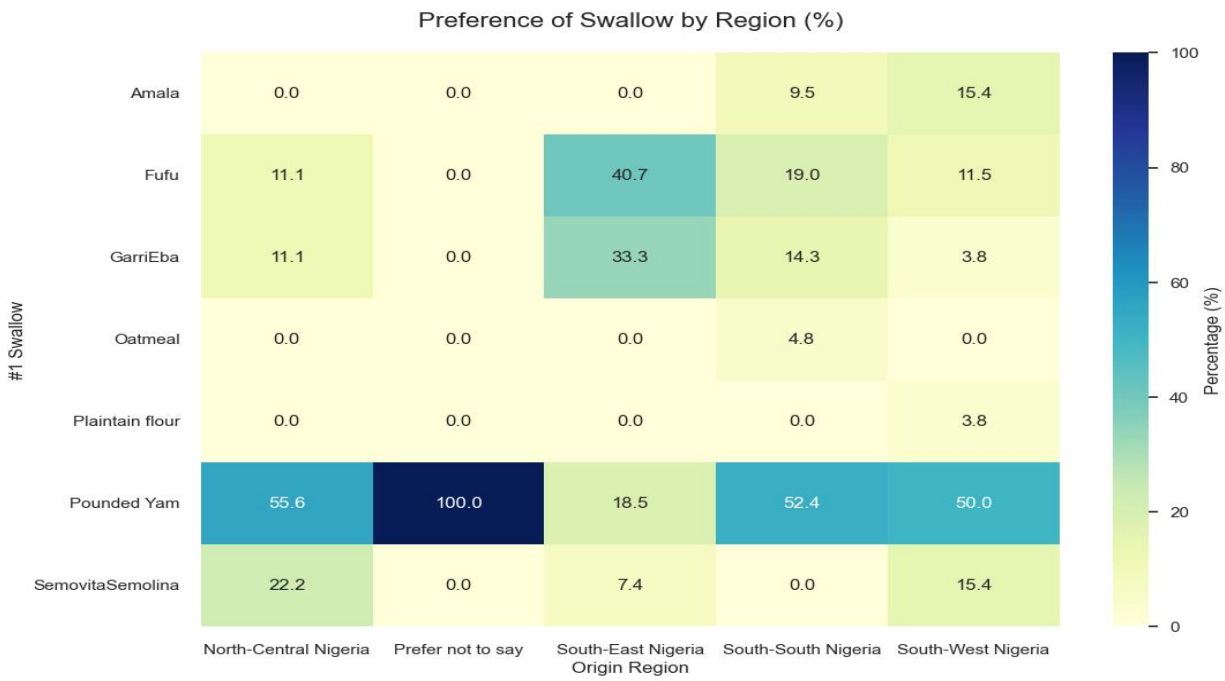


FIG 1.7



High urgency here indicates the percentage of swallow lovers in each category who would like their favorite to be made in premium format and are optimistic about it.

FIG 1.8



This diagram shows the swallow preferences of people by their region of birth.

We then look at some specialized questions and concepts.

Let's look at fufu_lovers(those who picked fufu as their number one swallow) and the percentage of fufu_lovers that eat swallow frequently. Now we never asked whether these people eat their number one swallows frequently, because people might eat swallows other than just their favorite and might no even know how much or overestimate a particular swallow. But they will be able to easier guess how much they eat swallows in general. Also something might be preventing them from eating their favorite swallow, and it might be not being able to find one that is clean, convenient or other factors. But finding out how many times they eat swallow is key to knowing how much they would buy their favorite swallow if the barriers were removed. The code result is below:

```
4. Fufu #1 lovers: 18 ( 20.9% of total)
% of Fufu #1 lovers who eat swallow frequently:
50.0%
```

Then we look at another metric, urgency. We asked two questions in the questionnaire, one on whether the respondents would like their swallow in a premium format, and secondly whether they are optimistic that this premium format will be as good as the first one. I thought and said that those who answer yes to both questions are the ones with high urgency, but then I figured that a person might want a premium format and not be optimistic that the premium will be as good as the traditional because of disappointments with other premium products. But for those who wanted a premium and thought that it would taste good. We called it the urgency condition. The raw code is shown below:

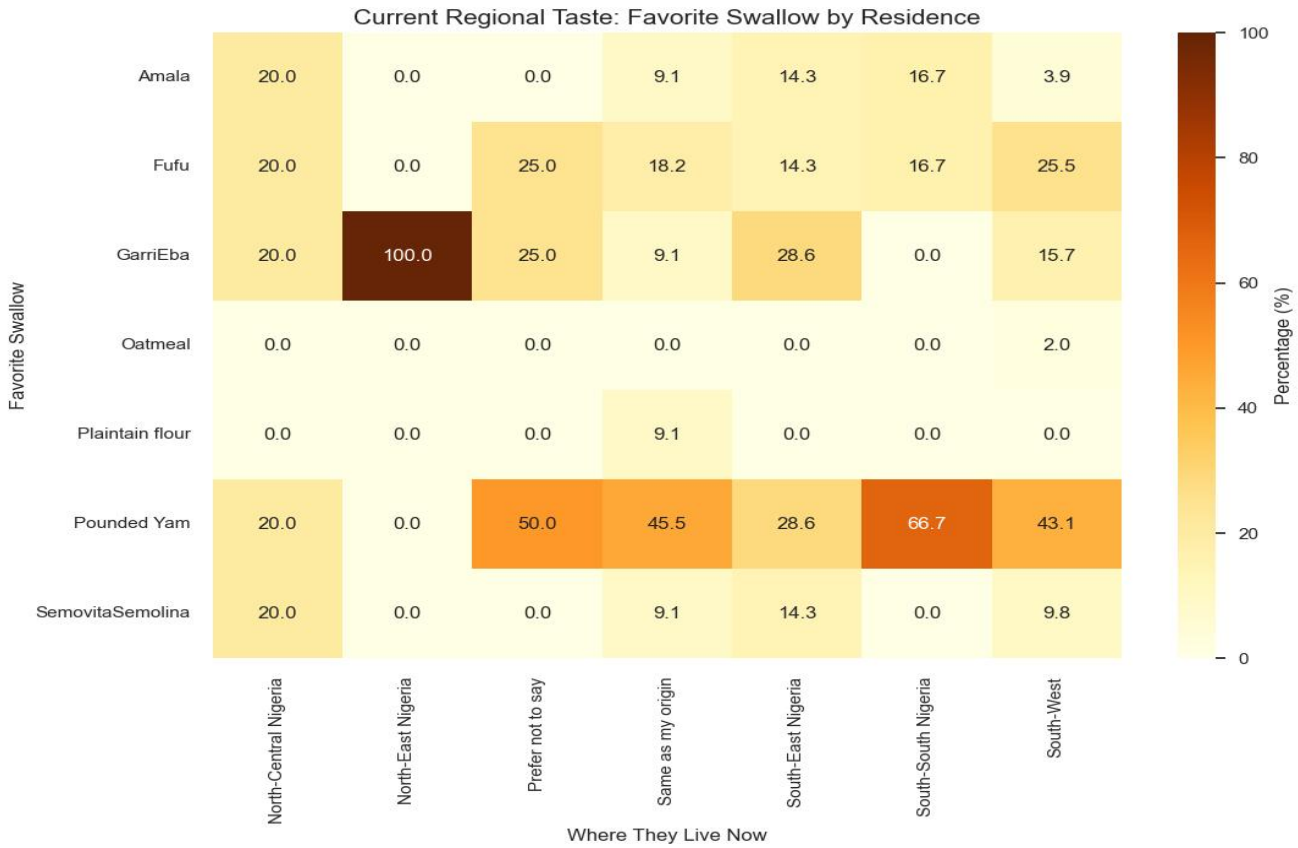
```
urgency_cond = df['Would you like your number one swallow to be available in premium format?( easy pour granules or powder ready in or under 15 mins, no pounding or long preparation)'] == 'Very interested'

optimism_cond = df['How optimistic are you that a high quality instant version could taste close to the traditionally made one?'].isin(['Very optimistic-I would buy regularly if it tastes good', 'Somewhat optimistic'])

df['high_urgency'] = urgency_cond & optimism_cond
```

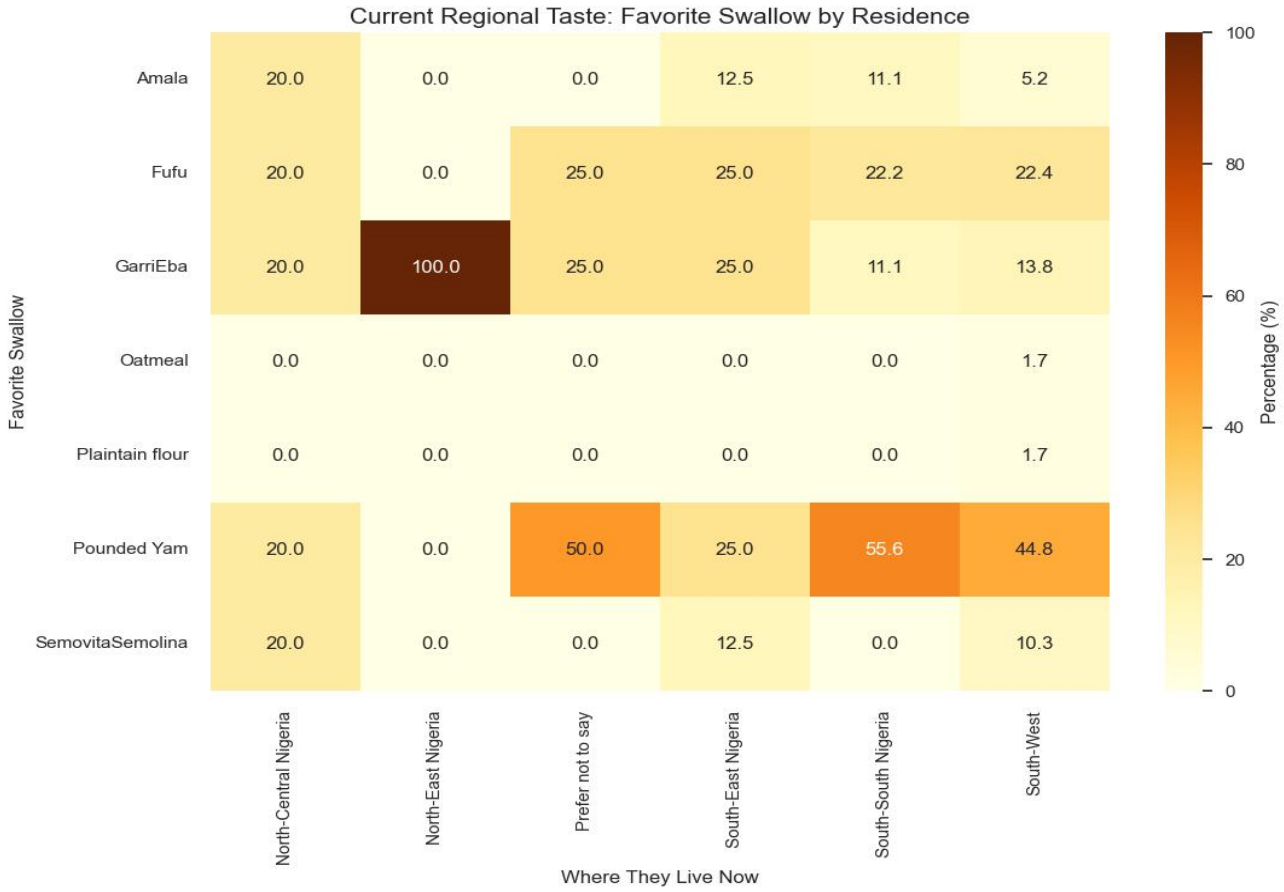
So we did the urgency condition for fufu and by each number one swallow. But let's see the total breakdown of our first batch of code:

```
Total responses: 86n
Top #1 favourite swallows:
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
Pounded Yam          42.4%\n
Fufu                 21.2%\n
Garri/Eba            16.5%\n
Semovita/Semolina     9.4%\n
Amala                 7.1%\n
Fufu/                 1.2%\n
Plaintain flour       1.2%\n
Oatmeal               1.2%\n
Name: proportion, dtype: object
Swallow eating frequency:
Do you eat swallows(Eba/Garri, Fufu/Akpu, Wheat, Oatmeal, Pounded Yam, Amala, ...etc)
A few times a week    54.1%\n
Weekl                 24.7%\n
Monthly               10.6%\n
Daily                  5.9%\n
Rarely                 4.7%\n
Name: proportion, dtype: object
Origin zones breakdown:
Which region are you from?
South-East Nigeria       31.8%\n
South-West Nigerua       30.6%\n
South-South Nigeria      24.7%\n
North-Central Nigeria    10.6%\n
Prefer not to say         2.4%\n
Name: proportion, dtype: object
fufu #1 lovers: 18 (20.9% of total)
% of Fufu #1 lovers who eat swallow frequently:
```

```
Frequent swallow eaters: 51 out of len86 (59.3%)
High urgency rate among branched respondents (86 people):
High urgency by #1 swallow:
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
Amala                  0.0%
Fufu                  22.2%
Fufu/                  0.0%
Garri/Eba              0.0%
Oatmeal                0.0%
Plaintain flour      100.0%
Pounded Yam           16.7%
Semovita/Semolina      0.0%
Name: high_urgency, dtype: object
```

So we see that among those with the highest urgency I.e those that want their swallow in a premium format and are optimistic that it would taste like the traditional, fufu is the highest as 22.2 percent. It has been shown in the figure above. We have also looked at favorite swallow by region and seen that fufu is the favorite in the South-east. In Python we can find the data hidden within the data. We can want to find out whether it is residence that influences taste or upbringing. We asked the questions, where are you from, and where do you live?. So we could do a heatmap showing the favorite swallow by residence. It is shown below





We know migration is a thing, so these figures should not confuse us as to why Amala is highest in the North-Central and why fufu is the highest in the South-west. With a quick test for migration, we would find out. We asked the question where do you live and some people picked the answer “Same as my origin”, we see that those in same as my origin occupied over 18.1 of the fufu market and 45.5 percent of people in that category live in the same area they were born.

So we created a True origin region column, where if anyone said “Same as my origin”, we would replace that answer with the answer in “Where do you come from” or “Where were you born”. See the data with the True origin values.

True_Current_Region North-Central Nigeria \
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
Amala 20.0
Fufu 20.0
GarriEba 20.0
Oatmeal 0.0
Plaintain flour 0.0
Pounded Yam 20.0
SemovitaSemolina 20.0

True_Current_Region North-East Nigeria \
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
Amala 0.0
Fufu 0.0
GarriEba 100.0
Oatmeal 0.0
Plaintain flour 0.0
Pounded Yam 0.0
SemovitaSemolina 0.0

True_Current_Region Prefer not to say \
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
Amala 0.0
Fufu 25.0
GarriEba 25.0
Oatmeal 0.0
Plaintain flour 0.0
Pounded Yam 50.0
SemovitaSemolina 0.0

True_Current_Region South-East Nigeria \
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
Amala 12.5
Fufu 25.0
GarriEba 25.0
Oatmeal 0.0
Plaintain flour 0.0
Pounded Yam 25.0
SemovitaSemolina 12.5

True_Current_Region	South-South Nigeria	South-West
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow		
Amala	11.1	5.2
Fufu	22.2	22.4
GarriEba	11.1	13.8
Oatmeal	0.0	1.7
Plaintain flour	0.0	1.7
Pounded Yam	55.6	44.8
SemovitaSemolina	0.0	10.3

Now we can look at what we call loyalty and diagnostic probabilities. Loyalty statistics says how much a tribe is loyal to something. It asks what is the probability that a person from this tribe will have fufu as number one swallow. That is different from the probability that a person who has fufu as number one swallow will come from a particular tribe. For example if 40 percent of south-easterners love fufu, and 80 percent of all our fufu lovers are from south east. The loyalty probability is 0.4 for south east, but our diagnostic, or flipped probability is more useful. It tells us where to site our market. So even if only 40 percent of easterners like fufu, if they are 80 percent of our market, where else will we find customers. It is necessary to flip probabilities at times to get more insight. Since fufu is seen to be the have the highest percentage of number one swallow in the South-east and South-South, we do the analysis. The results of some analysis is shown below:

=== STEP 6: LOYALTY VS DIAGNOSTIC PROBABILITIES ===

Loyalty Probabilities(P(Fufu #1| Group))
P(Fufu #1|SS/SE Origin): 29.2%
P(Fufu #1|South-West residents): 25.5%
P(Fufu #1|South-South residents):nan%
P(Fufu #1|South-East residents):nan%

Diagnostic probabilities (P(Group|Fufu #1))
P(SE/SS origin |Fufu #1): 77.8%
P(Frequent eater | Fufu #1):50.0%
P(High Urgency | Fufu #1, branched): 22.2%

Concentration: P(SE or SS| Fufu #)
77.8%

This is conditional probability. The P(A/B) means the probability of A given B has occurred. So the P(Group/Fufu #1) means the probability of a person being from a particular group given that they love fufu. That means we have this formula

(number of persons from X group that love fufu as number 1)/Total number of persons that love fufu.

The Probability(Fufu #1/Group) means the probability of a person loving fufu given that they are from a particular group. That means we have this ratio

(Number of persons from a particular group that love fufu as number 1)/Total number of persons from that particular group.

So let's say we have a group, South-east, we have fufu lovers, garri lovers …etc. The probability of a person from the south-east loving fufu is P(FUFU #1/ SOUTH-EAST). the flipped side is we have a bunch of fufu lovers, and we have people from all tribes there. What percentage of these fufu lovers are from south-west, south east. Then we have P(SOUTH-EAST/FUFU #1). So I hope that is cleared. So if this latter number is high, regardless of the former, this flipped probability is real. And there is need to ditinguish them. Many people make the mistake that, what is the probability that a person loves fufu and is from the south-east as if there are no inverse probabilities within different sets with similar variables. So P(A/B) is not the same as P(B/A). Know this and know peace.

And as our data shows, the probability of a person from the south-east loving fufu is about 29.2 percent . While the probability that among our fufu lovers, a person is from the south-east is 77.8 percent. This means that that place is our target market alright.

But urgency is also another thing. If they are urgent, meaning they want a premium version and are optimistic it will be like the traditional giving them easier preparation and convenience, it would be perfect, but that is not always the case.

We asked general questions like,
1. "Do you want your number one swallow to be available in a premium format?", and
2. "Are you optimistic that the premium format would be close to the original in quality". These were general questions on swallow not just on Fufu. So everyone with their number one swallow would have a different answer or similar, of course we don't know, but let us check the data.

We want to check those that were urgent for their number one swallow to be in premium format and were not optimistic, or to put the correct term, skeptical. So these set of respondents would have ticked, "very interested" in the first question and "Not sure/Not optimistic-Doubt it can match traditional", in the second question

Just 2.3 % of the respondents were desperate but skeptical and their favorite swallows were pounded Yam.

We also created another column called the High urgency column. These set of persons answered very interested in the first question , and very optimistic in the second question. This means they are both interested and optimistic that it would taste good.These were about 12.8 percent of our respondents. We checked this urgent set of persons by place of birth/origin. Our results are shown below:

```
=== STEP 7: URGENCY & PREMIUM DEMAND===

High urgency rate(among branched 86 people): 12.8%

High urgency by origin zone:
Which region are you from?
North-Central Nigeria    11.1%\n
Prefer not to say         0.0%\n
South-East Nigeria        7.4%\n
South-South Nigeria      14.3%\n
South-West Nigeria       19.2%\n
```

We also created a column called the triad. This triad is a combo of frequent eaters who are interested in a premium format and are optimistic that it will be good. So they are our core set of persons. They will have high demand for swallow and for our product given that a bunch of them like our product. They are basically frequent eaters with a high urgency. We checked the persons that met all three conditions, for their number one swallow. The results are shown below:

```
Triad(frequent+high frequency):7 people ( 8.1% of total)
Triad by #1 swallow
What is your absolute #1 favorite swallow
Pounded Yam    57.1%
Fufu           42.9%
```

We also analyzed the triad by where they come from. The results are below:

```
Triad by origin zone:
Which region are you from?
South-West Nigeria     57.1%\n
South-South Nigeria    28.6%\n
South-East Nigeria     14.3%\n
```

There is a high possibility that all people from south west are also those that have pounded Yam as their favorite but we do not know yet. Also there is also a high possibility that all people from South-south or South-East would love fufu. But to confirm this, we need to calculate the probability of all fufu lovers being from the

South-east or south west and all Pounded Yam lovers being from South-West. They are shown below(including the flipped probabilities):

```
P(South-West Nigeria|Pounded_Yam_no1): 36.1%
P(Pounded_Yam_no1|South-West Nigeria): 50.0%
P(Fufu #1|SS/SE Origin): 33.3%
P(SS/SE Origin|Fufu #1): 80.0%
```

This shows that among people who say pounded yam is their favorite, only 36.1% are from the South-West. This means pounded Yam lovers are spread out, and it is not just a cultural meal. The data reveals that among persons who are from the South-West, about half of them are pounded yam lovers. Even culturally, pounded Yam is not a universal meal. Among those that are from either South-East or South-South, 33.3 percent of them love fufu. Looking at the set of persons that love fufu, about 80% of them are either from the SS or SE.

Now for a lot of persons in our small sample of 86, where they live now is not where they grew up. So we have to account for migration in the urgency we are trying to infer from the data. So we checked for Migration patterns, and high urgency. The results are shown below:

```
. Migration: 75 migrants (87.2%)
Top Origin > current moves:
Which region are you from?  Where do you currently live?
South-East Nigeria          South-West                      20
South-West Nigeria          South-West                      14
South-South Nigeria         South-West                      12
South-West Nigeria          Same as my origin                7
North-Central Nigeria       South-West                       5
South-South Nigeria         Same as my origin                3
South-West Nigeria          South-East Nigeria               2
                            Prefer not to say                1
                            North-East Nigeria               1
                            North-Central Nigeria            1
dtype: int64
Stayers(same origin/current): 11 (12.790698%)
Fufu #1 preference:
 stayers: 9.1%
 migrants: 22.7%

High urgency
 stayers: 27.3%
 migrants: 10.7%
```

Now we can have a very different understanding of what is going on here. Stayers in our dataset are just 12.8% of our sample. A couple of them have migrated from their places of birth. Migrants on the other hand are 87.2% percent of our sample. We can see that although the South-West has the largest number of occupants in the sample, a lot of them are migrants from other place. Among the total number of persons living in the South-West, 20 are from the South-East, 12 from the South-South, 5 from North-Central. Only 3 people from the South-South in our destination are still living

in the South-South. So when it says pounded yam has a high prominence among those living in the south-south, we must understand that only about 20 percent of people from the South-South are actually still living in the South-South. And when we see that 52.4 percent of persons from the South-South have a strong preference for Pounded Yam, we must understand that 80 percent of them live in the South-West. In essence it seems that location seems to play a stronger role in swallow preferences than place of origin. But we cannot conclude on that yet.

```
South-West residents: 58
Fufu #1 among them: 22.4%

Of South-West residents, migrants: 58 (100.0%)
Fufu #1 among migrants to SW: 22.4%
Fufu #1 among SW natives: nan%


South-West residents: 58 (all migrants)

Top origins of migrants to South-West:
Which region are you from?
South-West Nigeria       21
South-East Nigeria       20
South-South Nigeria      12
North-Central Nigeria     5
Name: count, dtype: int64

Fufu #1 in SW residents: 22.4%
High urgency in SW residents (branched): 5.9%
```

From this data output above, we can see that all the fufu lovers in the South-West among 20-29 population are migrants. About 63.8 percent of South-Western residents in the sample are migrants. We can see that fufu is preferred among migrants than stayers. Since most of the persons living in the South-West are migrants, and probably based in Lagos. We can deduce that among the young population, about a fifth should have fufu as their number one swallow. We also know that most of the migrants are from the South-East or South-South. So if fufu is preferred among migrants, that probably means migrants carried fufu preference with them to Lagos. And south-West and south-south almost have equal footings. The prob(Fufu #1 | from the SS OR SE) is 33.3%, but individually, it is about 40.7% for the SE and 19% for SS. In terms of residency, in every region of Nigeria, fufu has at least a fifth who have it as top swallow. So Fufu has a very strong presence as a swallow contender in Nigeria.

We now examined the 1st, 2nd and 3rd choices of people's favorite swallow. The results are shown below:

```
== FUFU LATENT DEMAND BOUNDS ===

Fufu #1 (Loyalists): 23.3%
Fufu in Top 2 (Strong latent demand): 46.5%
Fufu in Top 3 (Total reachable market): 65.1%

Fufu weighted score (average points across all respondents):
1.35 / 3.00 possible

=== PRIME SWITCHERS (Pounded Yam #1 + Fufu in Top 3) ===

Number of Prime Switchers: 22
Market share of Switchers: 25.6%

Prime Switchers' origin zones:
Which region are you from?
South-West Nigeria       40.9%\n
South-South Nigeria      22.7%\n
South-East Nigeria       18.2%\n
North-Central Nigeria    13.6%\n
Prefer not to say         4.5%\n
Name: proportion, dtype: object
Prime Switchers' current residence:
Where do you currently live?
South-West               59.1%\n
South-South Nigeria      13.6%\n
Same as my origin         9.1%\n
Prefer not to say         9.1%\n
South-East Nigeria        4.5%\n
North-Central Nigeria     4.5%\n
Name: proportion, dtype: object
Most common 2nd choice for Pounded Yam #1 lovers:
Rank your top 3 favorite swallows [Garri/Eba]
3rd choice    52.0%
2nd choice    48.0%
Name: proportion, dtype: object

Most common 3rd choice for Pounded Yam #1 lovers:
Rank your top 3 favorite swallows [Fufu/Akpu]
3rd choice    59.1%
2nd choice    40.9%
Name: proportion, dtype: object
```

Prime switchers are people who have pounded Yam as top swallow but have fufu in their top 3 swallows. So among pounded yam lovers, who among them has fufu in top 3. We do this because people do not always eat their favorite swallow, and sometimes eat their second favorite when the favorite is unavailable or they have tired from it for a while and need something new. The number of prime switchers is around 25.6 percent. And majority of the prime switchers are from the South-west, and then from the south-south. Majority of the prime switchers also live in the South-West and then the South-South.

Examining the most common second choice for pounded Yam lovers, we see that 52.0 percent of poundo lovers had garri as second choice. Supposing poundo is not available, it is garri they will eat. For fufu, about 59.1 percent of yam lovers had fufu as second choice. This means that we still have a market for fufu among yam lovers.

Some major points to note from the data is that the South-West region is really just a fair combination of people from other tribes among young persons aged 20-29. Pounded Yam and Fufu are not top tribal foods in that sense but the top preferred swallow on average across all tribes. The South-East is a major zone because about 80 percent of fufu lovers come from there. They may have migrated to the South-West taking fufu love with them.

We can therefore conclude that Fufu is the second most preferred swallow among young persons in Nigeria from all regions. Given its preference in the south-west, and a bulk of south-western residents are migrants. Fufu and Pounded Yam are national favorites, not just cultural delicacies.